

FIMI-ISAC Incident Alert: 0097. TLP: CLEAR			Date
Title	CZ	Russian state affiliated outlet neČT24 promoting election fraud narratives	02/10/2025

Summary

- Russian state affiliated outlet neČT24 is actively and systematically posting content on their social media accounts (Telegram, X and Facebook) attempting to undermine the integrity of the upcoming Czech parliamentary elections.
- The outlet regularly posts content propagating election fraud narratives. Recent claims have included a decontextualised video claiming that the Constitutional Court of the Czech Republic wants to manipulate the elections, or that there will be another “Romanian scenario”. This suggests that the annulment of the December 2024 Romanian election on account of coordinated inauthentic behaviour (CIB) was fabricated and will again be used in Czechia as a pretext to manipulate elections and suspend potential candidates.
- The reach of posts from neČT24 varies between platforms but appears highest on Telegram (between 6,600 and 8,000 views). While the reach of posts was limited on Facebook and X, it reinforces the rigged election narrative and concerns of 47% of population that the current government might manipulate elections to stay in power.
- Recommendations: Better pro-active communication of public institutions about the integrity of elections, responsibilities and powers of individual institutions when it comes to the election’s oversight and electoral law; provision of more information and awareness raising about the DSA and its enforcement in Czechia.
- The technique reflects DISARM TTPs of leveraging new narratives and leverage of existing narratives, contextual omission and pre-emptive framing.

Incident

The Telegram [channel](#) neČT24 was established in the spring of 2022 and is operated by the same editorial team as the banned Russian state-affiliated news outlet Sputnik CZ (1). The Czech counterintelligence agency, the Security Information Service, concluded that neČT24 is “an information channel directly connected to the Russian state apparatus.” (2) NeČT24 also has an account on [X](#) and, as of September 1, has created a [Facebook page](#). These accounts are sharing content on all three platforms to increase their reach. NeČT24 and its affiliated accounts should be regarded as instruments of foreign information manipulation and interference (FIMI).

Throughout the election campaign, the social media channels and pages of neČT24 have promoted multiple narratives that questioned electoral integrity.

- On 18 September, the outlet published (3) an interview with sociologist Petr Sak, who claimed that the Constitutional Court or the President “will steal” the elections. The post received 10,800 views and nearly 300 reactions on Telegram (4). On Facebook, it gained 37 likes, 5 comments, and 22 shares (5).
- On 22 September, Facebook page (6), Telegram (7) and X account (8) of neČT24 published a 41-second video from a pre-election debate on CNN Prima News. In the video, Miroslav Ševčík, a candidate of the far-right SPD party, commented on a judicial proceeding concerning whether SPD and Stačilo! should be classified as a single party or as a coalition (a decision that would affect the electoral threshold for entering Parliament). Ševčík suggested that the Constitutional Court’s involvement might be preparation for a “Romanian scenario”—preventing the candidacy of an undesirable political actor—arguing that constitutional judges are biased. While the video

accurately reflects Ševčík's statements, it omits the broader context of the debate and highlights only his remarks undermining trust in the electoral process and judicial independence.

- neČT24 also presented the Rapid Response System (RRS) as a last-ditch effort to manipulate the elections (9, 10). This narrative appeared in interviews with opposition figures Josef Nerušil and Vladimír Zlínský
 - o Josef Nerušil: Telegram posts (11, 12) on 25 and 26 September, each post gaining around 7,000 views and several hundred interactions; Facebook one post (13) on 25 September, with 11 likes, 1 comment, and 2 shares
 - o Vladimír Zlínský: Telegram posts (14, 15) on 26 and 29 September, each gaining about 7,500 views; Facebook one post (16) on 29 September, with 8 likes, 1 comment, and 5 shares).
- In reaction to media reporting about CIB network of accounts promoting Russian propaganda and oppositional parties on TikTok neČT24 published multiple posts claiming that it is another attempt to create pretext for questioning of electoral results. The claims about "Romanian scenario" appeared in multiple posts – on Telegram on 28th September (17) (7,500 views and nearly 400 interactions), two posts on 29th September (18, 19) (each around 7,500 views and 300 interactions) and two posts (20, 21) on 30th September (one with nearly 8,000 views and more than 400 interaction and the other with 6,600 views and roughly 250 interactions). On neČT24 X account two posts related (22, 23) to this topic were published on 29th September (both gaining around 200 views and 10 interactions). On Facebook one post (24) was published on 30th September gaining 17 likes, 1 comment and 2 shares.

These claims reinforce the long-circulating narrative that the current government intends to manipulate elections to remain in power. The post fits into neČT24's broader tactic of promoting narratives that question electoral integrity.

Systemic violation assessment:

1. Why does this incident represent a risk?

This incident represents a risk because it spreads narratives that undermine trust in elections, courts, and democratic institutions. By convincing users that the government intends to manipulate results, it can discourage voter participation, polarize society, and weaken confidence in democratic processes.

2. Why does this incident constitute manipulation of information? Where does this manipulation lie?

The manipulation lies both in the content and the tactics. The outlet spreads narratives that undermine trust in elections by framing elections as "stolen" and judges as biased, while selectively amplifying statements without context. It also relies on coordinated, cross-platform posting to maximize reach and impact.

3. Could this type of manipulation be illegal in the monitored country?

Possibly. As the accounts is clearly linked to Russia and the former account of banned Sputnik outlet.

Narrative

Meta narrative: "Deep state" tries to manipulate democratic processes; "patriotic" policies are suppressed

Sub-narratives: Czech Constitutional Court in cooperation with government tries to manipulate election; "Romanian" scenario serves as template for suppression of "inconvenient" voices

Impact

Reach:

Post about the Constitutional Court

Telegram: 7,420 views and little more than 400 reactions

X: 9,142 views, 187 likes and 42 shares
FB: 15 likes, 1 comment and 1 share

Petr Sak:
Telegram: 10,800 views and nearly 300 reactions
Facebook 37 likes, 5 comments and 22 shares

Josef Nerušil
Telegram: 7,000 views, and more than 200 interactions
Facebook: the post gained 11 likes, 1 comment and 2 shares

Vladimír Zlínský
Telegram 7,500 views, more than 200 interactions
Facebook 8 likes, 1 comment, and 5 shares).

Post about Romanian scenario
Telegram: 6,600-8,000 views and 250-400 interactions
X: 200 views and 10 interactions
Facebook: 17 likes, 1 comment and 2 shares.

Outcome: Speculations about potential manipulation of electoral procedures are shaping public perception at least since January 2025. According to sociological research from September 2024, 47% of Czechs are concerned that the current government or its supporters will manipulate elections to stay in power.

Whole research available at:

<https://cedmohub.eu/cs/nizka-informovanost-o-korespondencni-volbe-a-silna-predvolebni-neduvera-v-socialni-site-i-vladu-pravidla-korespondencni-volby-nezna-68-lidi/>

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective 1: Discredit – Undermining trust in electoral institutions, courts, and the Rapid Response System by suggesting bias or manipulation.

Objective 2: Distort – Selectively presenting information (e.g., Ševčík's remarks) to emphasize claims undermining judicial independence without context

TTP 1 - Leveraging new narratives and sub-narratives about RSS and Romanian Scenario that fit wider narrative of planned election fraud

TTP 2 - leverage of existing narratives of allegedly planned election fraud

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Actions Taken: No specific action taken against this particular group of posts, but the topic of speculation about electoral manipulations is widely covered in media; state authorities communicated to the public information on how electoral process is protected from manipulations.

Recommendations: More proactive communication from public institutions about the integrity of elections as well as increased public knowledge about the DSA are important to increase resilience against these narratives.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	FIMI Assessment
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N/A	Russia	3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, Richard 14, 15, 16, Kuchta, Website, 17, 18, 19, Jonas Telegram, 20, 21, 22, Syrovatka, X, High 23 ISD Facebook certainty/attributed
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